Defense Agreement, the ambassador said he did not have instructions about the nature of American assistance being requested. Rusk said he would refer the request to the president, but reiterated that if the India-Pakistan conflict ceased, it would render the question moot. He also mentioned the US warning via the Warsaw channel.[248]

The next day, Shastri's senior aide Lakshmi Kant (L. K.) Jha told Bowles that India had detected signs of Chinese troop movements and asked if the US would "authorize US personnel to consult with Indian military planners on [a] contingency basis."[249] While the ambassador recommended that the US do so, Washington told him that Johnson had not authorized joint contingency planning at that point.[250] Subsequently, Under Secretary of State George Ball reiterated to B. K. Nehru that the US would not undertake pre-emptive planning with India, noting that Washington would review the situation if China attacked. He also restated that the US believed any public warning would be provocative, and thus would not be forthcoming at that stage.[251]

On September 19, the killing of three Indians in a "small-scale fire fight" with China in Ladakh and an "abnormally high rate" of military communications activity in southwest China had American intelligence concerned.[252] Those developments reduced the impact of Beijing extending its deadline, as did its firing across the Sikkim border and what India considered intrusion into its territory. Shastri told parliament that China was looking for an "excuse" for aggression.[253] Privately, the Indian government told Beijing that their referring to events in 1962 was particularly "ominous."[254] At the UN, the US ambassador warned against Chinese involvement, and the US and Soviet Union voted for a resolution calling for a ceasefire, as well as for countries to refrain from aggravating the situation.[255]

By this point, however, with the Chinese extension, a deteriorating military position, and the possibility of US military involvement because of China's threats, Pakistan seemed ready to compromise. Meanwhile, the concern about Chinese intervention, US ambiguity about its response, and the situation on the ground seemed to have brought India to the same point. On September 22, India and then Pakistan announced that they would accept the UN ceasefire proposal.[256] Jha specified concern about China as a crucial reason for India agreeing to a ceasefire.[257] Subsequently, intelligence